YUJIN ZHANG

Contact Information

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
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Education

Columbia University in the City of New York, NY 2019-2026 (Expected)
Ph.D., Political Science
- Fields: International Relations (Major), Comparative Politics
- Dissertation: Early-Life Experiences and Global Public Opinions on Economic Policymaking
- Committee: Allison Carnegie (Co-Chair), Nikhar Gaikwad (Co-Chair), Junyan Jiang, Calvin Thrall

M. Phil., Political Science 2022
M.A., Political Science 2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C. 2018
M.A., International Political Economy and International Economics

Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO 2016
B.A., magna cum laude, Business Administration

Hunan University, Changsha, Hunan, China 2014
B.A., Finance

Research Interest

- Research Focus: International political economy, backlash against economic and political liberalism, economic security and statecraft, political socialization
- Regional Focus: East Asia, Developed Economies

Publication

[1] 2024. "Political Trust and Government Performance in the Time of COVID-19." ***World Development*** 176 (106499), with Chengyuan Ji and Junyan Jiang.
– **Keywords:** Health governance, political trust

Working Paper

[7] "Assistance to Me, and to Thee: Early Inequality Experiences and Public Preferences for Overseas Aid." (Under Review)
– **Keywords:** Foreign Aids, Inequality, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, Developed Countries

[6] "Inflation of Populism: Effects of Early Economic Experiences on Support for Populist Parties." (Under Review)
– **Keywords:** Inflation, Populism, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, European Politics

[5] "Rethinking Backlash against Trade Openness: Import–Export Preferences in Two Dimensions" with Ziwen Zu. (Under Review)
– **Previous Title:** "Why Mercantilism?"
– **Keywords:** Globalization Backlash, Mercantilism, Isolationism, Survey Experiment, United States and China
– **Presentations:** APSA 2026, GSIPE-APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025

[4] "Partisan Responses to Economic Shocks: Inflation Crises and the Paradox of Trade Liberalization."

– **Keywords:** Inflation crisis, trade liberalization, political parties, electoral politics
– **Presentations:** APSA 2025, MPSA 2025

[3] "International Competition and Technological Preferences: Evidence from the United States and China." with Ziwen Zu.
– **Keywords:** Technological globalization, AI, geopolitical competition, U.S. & China, survey experiment
– **Presentations:** APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025

[2] "Prosperity and Openness: Early Globalization Experiences and Mass Preferences for Free Trade." (Under Review)
– **Keywords:** Formative experiences, trade preferences, East and Southeast Asia
– **Presentations:** APSA 2024, MPSA 2024

[1] "Aversion to What?: Early-Life Economic Experiences and Responses to Inflation."
– **Keywords:** Formative experiences, macroeconomic attitudes, Europe
– **Presentations:** APSA 2023

Research In Progress

[4] "Nationalist, United?"

[3] "On Industrial Policies."

[2] "Environmental and Electoral Consequences of the Trade War."

[1] "Life Experiences and Attitudes toward Military Alliance." with Allison Carnegie and Elizabeth Saunders.

Other Publication

[1] 2018. "China's Coal-to-Gas Program: A Developing Environmental Governance Regime." *SAIS Review of International Affairs*.

Teaching Experience

Columbia University

- Politics of International Economic Relations, Prof. Jeffry Frieden — Fall 2024
- Chinese Politics, Prof. Junyan Jiang — Fall 2021, Spring 2023
- China's Foreign Relations, Prof. Thomas Christensen — Spring 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2025
- International Politics, Prof. Alexander de la Paz — Spring 2022
- Autocracy and Democracy, Prof. Timothy Frye — Fall 2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

- Advanced Topics in International Trade (Graduate), Prof. Hiau Looi Kee — Spring 2018

Research Assistance

Columbia University

- Prof. Nikhar Gaikwad — 2022-25
- Prof. Junyan Jiang — 2021-23, 25

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

- Prof. Ling Chen — 2017-19
- Prof. David Steinberg — 2018-19

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

C. Martin Wilbur Fellowship, Weatherhead East Asian Institute	2025
Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies ($7500)	2025
CPE Graduate Student Grant, Columbia Center for Political Economy ($7000)	2025
Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies ($3000)	2024
Finalist, NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024
Dissertation Fellowship, Columbia University	2023-24
Travel Grant, Columbia University	2023-25
Travel Grant, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2022

Teaching Fellowship, Columbia University	2020-23, 24
Weatherhead East Asian Institute Fellowship, Columbia University	2019-20
Travel Grant, International Studies Association	2019
SAIS Fellowship, SAIS, Johns Hopkins University	2017-18
Dean's List, Colorado State University	2014-15
Global Partnership Fellow, Colorado State University	2014-16

Conferences and Workshops

GSIPE APSA Pre-Conference Workshop	2026
Virtual International Political Economy Society	Winter/Spring 2024
NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024
GSIPE Mini-Conference	2024
Northeast Regional Workshop in European Politics	2023
GSIPE APSA Workshop	2022
Political Science Speaker Series	2021

American Political Science Association Annual Conference [c, d×4, p×2]	2026
Graduate Students in International Political Economy-APSA Pre-Conference	2026
International Studies Association Annual Conference [c, p×2]	2026
International Political Economy Society Annual Meeting [p×2]	2025
Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop [d,p]	2025
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference [c, p]	2025
Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop [d,p]	2024
American Political Science Association Annual Conference	2024
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference	2024
Graduate Students in International Political Economy Workshop [d,p]	2023
American Political Science Association Annual Conference	2023
International Studies Association Annual Conference	2019
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference	2018

$^*c = Chair, d = Discussant, p = Paper$

Skills

Languages: Mandarin (Native)
Programming: R, Stata, LaTeX

Service

Event Coordinator, Graduate Student in International Political Economy — 2024-25

Referee

Social Science Research / *World Development*

Professional Experience

US-China Business Council	2018-19
China Africa Research Initiative	2016-17, 2018-19
Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars	2018
Brookings Institution	2018

References

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Calvin Thrall
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